PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

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STAFF MEMO

Date: **May 3, 2025**

To: Board of Education

From: Dan Jung, Chief Operating Officer

Subject: Seismic

The average PPS school is approximately 76 years old, with most buildings constructed long before modern seismic resilience codes were established. As a result, the majority of PPS schools do not currently meet today's seismic safety standards. However, the district has made meaningful progress in improving seismic resilience across its facilities. To date, nine schools have been fully modernized to meet current seismic codes, with three more - Jefferson High School, Cleveland High School, and Ida B. Wells High School - currently in progress. In addition, PPS has completed six full seismic retrofits, implemented interior seismic upgrades at 12 schools, and carried out roof-level seismic bracing projects at dozens of sites. **In all approximately 75% of PPS schools have received some level of seismic upgrade since 2012.** These efforts have significantly strengthened the district's overall seismic preparedness, but substantial work remains to bring all schools up to current standards.

2024/25 Seismic Assessment and Prioritization

PPS is in the process of updating existing seismic conditions and project prioritization. This process is being accomplished in 3 steps:

1. Gather detailed seismic deficiency data at all schools - *Complete*
2. Obtain priority recommendations from structural engineer - *In Process*
3. Evaluate recommendations Using PPS priority criteria - *To Be Completed*

1. Seismic Deficiency Data - Complete

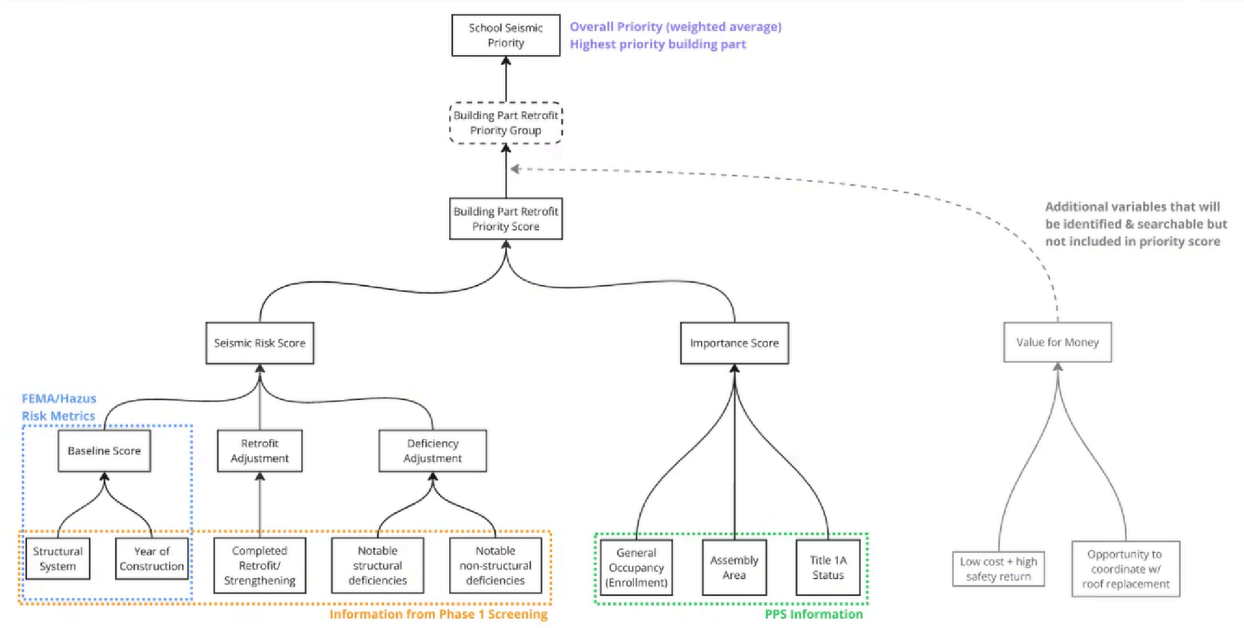
In mid-2024, a structural engineering consultant delivered a high level seismic assessment report for all school buildings. The high level assessment report includes seismic vulnerabilities and rough order of magnitude (ROM) construction costs to correct the vulnerabilities. A summary of the construction costs included in the report is below.

A	ROM Construction Cost to Seismically Retrofit ONLY Unreinforced Masonry (URM) at All Schools	$129,251,000
B	ROM Construction Cost for Full Seismic Retrofit at Schools that Contain Some URM	$340,050,875
C	ROM Construction Cost for Full Seismic Retrofits at Schools that do not Contain URM	$585,497,250
	Total ROM Construction Cost for Full Seismic Retrofits at all PPS Schools (B+C)	$925,548,125

Note: the above construction cost estimates provided by the structural engineer reflect only the hard construction costs and do not represent the total project cost. To arrive at a comprehensive project budget, several additional factors must be taken into account. These include soft costs (e.g., design services, permitting), required upgrades to meet City of Portland non-conforming standards (such as fire/life/safety systems and site improvements), construction phasing (if a project needs to be completed in a series of summers versus all at once) and any conditions of approval imposed by the City (such as street or sidewalk improvements). Cost escalation and other unforeseen requirements may also apply. When all of these factors are considered, the total project cost can exceed twice the estimated construction costs.

2. Priority Recommendations - In Progress

At the end of 2024, a new contract was established with the engineering firm to develop a prioritization of the identified seismic work documented in the 2024 assessment. The prioritization work includes collaborating with the District to define the criteria by which the work is prioritized, completing the prioritization, and developing a report as the work product for the prioritization effort. Some of the prioritization criteria are technical in nature and are calculated according to FEMA and American Society of Structural Engineers (ASCE) standards. Other criteria are defined or informed by the district: building enrollment, space type affected by the deficiency, and Title I status, for example. OSM Staff are collaborating with the structural engineering consultant to establish criteria that reflect the District's values and determine how much weight is assigned to each criterion. Currently, the report is anticipated to be finalized this summer. This is a significant step in the process for prioritizing our seismic retrofit scope in a way that is intentional and based on accepted industry standards. A *DRAFT* version of the prioritization algorithm is below.



3. PPS Priority Criteria - To Be Completed

The final and critical step for PPS will be to review the engineers' recommendations and apply its own priorities and criteria to determine which projects should move forward. While the recommendations from phases one and two will provide a strong data-driven foundation, PPS will need to consider additional factors outside the engineers' scope. These include anticipated impacts of potential school consolidation, the feasibility and consequences of multi-summer construction schedules, and potential disruptions to ongoing programs such as summer school. This internal evaluation will ensure that project decisions align with both operational realities and district-wide educational goals.